Portland State
UNIVERSITY

Information Systems in the News

Objective:
Connect course concepts with current events and deepen your ability to critically analyze how information systems (IS) impact, and are impacted by, real-world developments.

Part 1: Article Selection (Individual Work)

- You will select a recent news article (within the last 3 months) that relates to *any* aspect of Information Systems. The more recent the better.
- Approved sources include major business, tech, or news outlets (*NYT Technology*, *Wired*, *Bloomberg*, *TechCrunch*, *WSJ*, *The Verge*, etc.).
- Article topics could include: cybersecurity breaches, AI advancements, new SaaS models, government tech policy, data ethics, system outages, blockchain innovations, or any other topic from the term.
- Submit a short summary (100–150 words) describing:
    - What happened
    - Why it matters
    - How it connects to Information Systems

Part 2: Collaborative Theme Discussions (In-Class)

Students will be grouped based on thematic overlap (data ethics, automation, infrastructure, security breaches, AI, cloud computing, etc.). In groups of 3–5:

1. **Compare Articles:**
    - What trends are emerging or losing relevance?
    - Are there similarities in how systems are used or misused?
2. **Connect to Class Concepts:**
    - How does the news confirm, challenge, or expand what we've learned?
    - Does this news illustrate a trend we've discussed (e.g., cloud migration, network effects, the power of platforms)?
3. **Critical Questions for Discussion:**
    - Who benefits from the system(s) described in the article? Who is left out?
    - What assumptions about data, technology, or users are being made?
    - What ethical, social, or strategic questions does this news raise?

    - Does the author appear to support or critique the technology or system being discussed? What language or framing gives you that impression?

Part 3: Group Presentation

- Each group gives a **3–5 minute presentation**:
    - Briefly summarize the key articles.
    - Explain the main theme or connection.
    - Present one takeaway insight from Section 3 above, “Critical Questions for Discussion.”
    - Pose one open-ended question for the class to consider.